But Britain did not reward India with self-rule. When the war ended, the government passed even harsher laws against the Indians! The Rowlatt Acts of 1919 made it against the law for *any* group to organize against the government. Gandhi knew this law was unfair. It was time to use truth force again.

Gandhi called for a *hartal* , or strike, to protest the Rowlatt Acts, on April 6, 1919. Word spread through newspapers and local meetings throughout India. For one day, Indians would not go to work. Shops, railways, and farms stopped for the day. Many Indians gathered peacefully during the *hartal* to spend the day fasting and praying. Gandhi was pleased with the result. “The whole of India from one end to the other, towns as well as villages, observed a complete *hartal* on that day. It was a most wonderful spectacle,” he said.



But in some cities, the *hartal* did not go well. Gandhi received news that some Indians had burned buildings and ripped up railroad tracks. In Amritsar, a number of British men were killed. Whether the Indians were peaceful or violent, police treated them the same. They beat the Indians with their brass-tipped sticks called *lathis* .